

Deploying a Ticket Request System **with OTRS**

In the current business scenario, customer management plays a major role in the success or failure of a company. Tracking issues and giving clients the necessary support and assistance in real time is crucial in providing quality service. This article covers an open source solution to help you in serving your customers with greater efficiency.



OTRS (Open-source Ticket Request System) is free and ticket-free system software that can be used to provide your customers a platform to raise issues that need to be resolved. This article leads you through the steps to deploy it and get a feel for it.

OTRS is based on Perl, so you must have Perl installed on your system. I am using RHEL6, which bundles the Perl packages, so all I need is to issue the `yum install perl*` command, and Perl will be installed. Now, you need to download OTRS before you can install and test it. Get it from <http://www.otrs.com/en/open-source/get-otrs/software-download/>. Once you have downloaded it, follow the steps indicated below:

- Double-click the RPM file or install it using the `rpm` command. It will also ask for a few dependencies to be installed, which you can do.
- OTRS runs on a Web-based interface, so you need to install Apache using the `yum install httpd*` command, and start the `httpd` service using the `service httpd start` command.
- Now, you need to install your database server—issue the `yum`

*install mysql** command to install the MySQL database, and then start the service with `service mysqld start`.

Now all the required packages are installed, and it's time to start the database configuration for OTRS. Follow the steps given below:

```
cd /opt/otrs
```

Open `/opt/otrs/README.database` to assist you in configuring the database for OTRS. I am using MySQL, so I'll go with the MySQL steps of this file. Issue the following commands at your command prompt:

```
mysql -u root -p -e 'create database otrs charset utf8'
mysql -u root -p otrs < scripts/database/otrs-schema.mysql.
sql
mysql -u root -p otrs < scripts/database/otrs-schema.mysql.
sql
mysql -u root -p otrs < scripts/database/otrs-initial_insert.
mysql.sql
```